LandLess

Solitaire Survival RPG

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Gameplay Introduction

**This introduction offers a concise overview of the game's core features, designed to help you quickly determine if LandLess aligns with your solitaire RPG interests. Please note that this is not a quickstart guide or an exhaustive rules explanation.*

If you're eager to dive straight into the adventure, feel free to skip ahead to page(7) for Lore introduction or page(17) for Rules introduction. Otherwise, read on for a brief glimpse of what awaits.

LandLess is a solo survival crafting rpg sandbox experience. Take some time to look over the instructions or dive right in with the quick guide and learn as you go. This book is an instruction set and an oracle with event elements and interactions and lore. You can reference the index in the front or back of the book and jump to specific rules if you like or read from front to back in normal order. This book will provide tables, items, descriptions, rule references, guides and other helpful data and story lore.

To begin, you will need a few supplies. A writing utensil like pen or pencil, some paper, some tokens or figures and a way to generate random numbers. You can use the provided character sheet or make your own. Other than that, this book is all you need for a self-contained experience. This doesn’t mean you can’t or shouldn’t make enhancements. The game is designed and balanced for the official ruleset for a solo experience. Nothing is preventing you from adding or removing rules as needed or wanted or even making it work for multiple people. The experience that is most fun to you is the correct experience. With that said, I do invite you to just let yourself submit to

the challenge for the intended experience. Accept the rules of the world you are in and succeed through adventure and experience.

Before diving any further, it’s best to know what this game is. I think labeling a game with a genre is helpful, but ultimately doesn't wrap up what the experience will be. Let’s make that part a little more clear. The tags in the title of this book include rpg, crafting, survival and sandbox. Because we have the format of a book, rpg can tell us that we have some level of interaction but also storytelling. Crafting implies that you can expect to gather resources in some way and use them to make useful items. Survival is a little bit ambiguous but, for this title, means you need to manage your character in a way that simulates harsh aspects of reality like the need for food and shelter to stay alive. Sandbox means you have no intended path. Just explore and play out the experience you uncover.

Let's get into more specifics. You will start by creating a character. This is done by generating attributes like Hp (Health Points) or faction affiliation and relationships among many other factors. This gives you a starting place and then you will generate your starting resources. You won’t have much and you have to progress to advance your various abilities that allow you to craft better items and interact with the world in more meaningful ways.

You have to manage your character’s hunger and thirst and maybe other needs depending on the biological features of your character. Beside your physical needs, you also need to maintain relationships. At an individual, faction and community level. NPCs in this game are not always friends or enemies. It comes down to the actions you take and the impact those actions have.

Items need to be stored. They have a weight and volume amount. You have a personal storage and vehicle storage where you can put items you need while traveling. These storages have smaller limits and storing too much can cause negative effects. You can also have a base with higher storage limits. You can also have a shop and store items with its own cost and benefits. Base items cannot be used directly, but they can be processed given you have the machines working. You can set the price of store items and they have a chance of selling when you are gone if you have a shop keeper of some kind. Watch out because possession of some items could get you in trouble.

This game has vehicles. Some are small and intended for individuals while others can be giant ships big enough to hold dozens of people and many various materials. Some ships have the ability to house machines for on-the-go production. All vehicles have attributes like speed, storage capacity, condition and others. You can purchase vehicles or obtain them in other ways.

There are a few requirements for crafting a given item or material. First, you need the skill. Second, you need the basic material. Third, you need the craft station, merchant or machine to complete the item. Some machines you will own and put in your base or ship for private use while others can only be used at their locations owned by an NPC. Machines can have different qualities for faster speed and less energy or resources and also make better items.

Currency in LandLess can be earned or even manufactured (more explanation later). Currency can be stored in person or in a bank. Keep in mind that the safety and security of your items and money isn’t guaranteed. You have a better chance of keeping it at the bank but have less opportunity to make use of it. The

lore of the game will explain more but, for now, know that currency is a little different in LandLess.

The last topic for the introduction will be time. Time is managed through time increments. Like seconds to minutes to hours, LandLess uses increments of Ticks (also makes more sense after reading the Action block Instructions). Ticks are the base unit of time. A tick is less than a second in real time but the actual time scale isn't the important part. We will use levels of time for calculating gameplay events and outcomes or resource and energy usage.

Movement is grid based. You move in a vehicle or make movements on vehicles or structures. When moving around, time will elapse and demand resource or energy use based on the time scales. Keep in mind that time is measured through in-game time units known as actions blocks. If it takes many in-game days to travel somewhere, you can use a longer action block or time scale as one movement. Dont worry too much about the specifics for right now, just know that the world is ever changing and a location might be different from the last time you visited. Like action blocks, area blocks can be divided to the smallest unit or into the largest. While you can generally move wherever you like for as long as you like, making big moves requires planning.

These gameplay elements are part of the core flow of LandLess. While gameplay supports both casual and hardcore(permadeath) game types, your character's history can influence future games either way. With a few tweaks, you could play hardocre rogue style or more of a long term campaign. Have a risky adventure or play the market. Craft items for your shop or plunder. The fate of your character depends on you.

Lore introduction

History

The state of Earth and its inhabitants in the early 2600s is a grim shadow of what anyone from centuries past might have envisioned. The global economy is a stagnant relic. Habitable territory is in constant, bloody dispute. Should one find themselves on any remaining sliver of dry land, the immediate priority becomes finding passage off it, whether by precarious boat or a sputtering airship. If the land itself isn't rendered uninhabitable by lingering radiation, it’s almost certainly overrun by feral Murlyn war-clans or the relentlessly invasive, self-replicating Reaver bots.

The vast majority of humanity has sought refuge on the waters. Over generations, sprawling colonies of urban flotsam have developed across the globe — massive, interconnected cities cobbled together from salvaged scrap and desperation. Some are tenuously anchored to the seabed, others drift aimlessly with the currents. These floating settlements are typically overcrowded and dangerously underdeveloped, their desperate patrons known for their hostility and fierce territoriality. For the native-born of this drowned Earth, a genuinely good life is a near-unreachable dream.

In stark contrast, the Terran colonies established beyond Earth's ravaged atmosphere have, for the most part, developed at an astonishing pace. Boasting robust economies and a frequent stream of scientific breakthroughs, these off-world habitats generally offer their citizens greater wealth and more abundant resources per individual. The chances of premature death are

significantly lower, and crime rates are but a fraction of those on Earth. Yet, life beyond Earth is not without its own shadows. Many asteroid miners report profound feelings of sadness and crushing isolation. Earth's own moon, Luna, while possessing pockets of prosperity, has largely become a dumping ground for society's undesirables and political exiles. In the void of space, work is relentlessly demanding, and absolute cooperation is often vital for survival, leaving little room for those who cannot fully dedicate themselves or who falter under the strain. For those struggling in the outer colonies, the thought of "dropping down" to Earth is often viewed as a one-way ticket to a particular kind of hell. The last significant bastion of order and opportunity off-world is often considered the Luna United Colonies (LUC). Once the undisputed leader in outer-Earth industry, the LUC has since evolved into the central organizational hub for much of the Sol system.

To understand how humanity arrived at this fractured and desperate juncture, we must journey back several hundred years, to a time of both unprecedented promise and gathering storms.

The Drowned World: The Nuclear Campfire Culture

The mid-21st century witnessed a pivotal transformation in human civilization, an era that would later be dubbed the "Nuclear Campfire Culture." Beginning in the 2060s, the global energy paradigm shifted dramatically. The catalyst was the widespread adoption of decentralized nuclear fission, allowing communities, large compounds, and sometimes even sprawling individual estates the option of energy independence from traditional grids.

While fusion technology remained an elusive dream for mass application, fission power had advanced significantly. The breakthrough originated in the African nation of Gabon, which leveraged its substantial uranium reserves to pioneer compact, relatively safe nuclear fission plants. Initially designed to energize remote African regions, Gabon's success in creating a private market for localized nuclear power generation soon inspired the rest of the industrialized world.

These new-generation plants, while engineered with advanced safety protocols, still required on-site personnel for monitoring and emergency response. The risk of meltdown or targeted attack, with potentially devastating local environmental consequences, remained a concern. An innovative solution emerged from an unexpected quarter: Buni Yadi, one of Gabon's earliest project sites in the Sahara. The village had become a burgeoning hub for researchers studying animal uplifting — the bioengineering of enhanced intelligence and specialized traits in animals. As wealth and population boomed, so did local conflicts, straining the security of the Buni Yadi reactor.

A researcher named Brailyn Spark, founder of 'Spark Biogenetics,' designed a new species of canine specifically for this challenge. These dogs, affectionately nicknamed 'Sparkies,' possessed a unique bio-engineered resilience, allowing their bodies to withstand and rapidly repair damage from significant radiation exposure. More remarkably, they were uplifted to a level of intelligence enabling them to comprehend and execute complex emergency shutdown sequences. After rigorous testing proved their capability, Sparkies were officially approved for use within nuclear facilities. This marked a watershed moment: the first successful integration of an uplifted animal species into human society as independent agents, complete with

employment rights, government identification, and financial responsibilities. Bioengineering ensured Sparkies could continue to adapt and learn, cementing their place as valued members of society in the ensuing Nuclear Campfire revolution.

With the tireless assistance of Sparkies and continuous nuclear advancements, humanity largely overcame its energy anxieties. The resulting surplus made electric motors exceptionally cheap and powerful. Though battery energy density remained a persistent challenge for electric vehicles, this was ingeniously circumvented by ultra-fast charging technology and a freely accessible public charging infrastructure. City planners, liberated from power generation concerns, focused on ensuring universal access to this abundant energy.

This energy renaissance had profound societal impacts. Multi-level vertical farming flourished, dramatically increasing global food availability. Potable water, through advanced desalination and purification, could theoretically be produced almost anywhere. However, the promise of a post-scarcity utopia was not universally realized. Political strife and regional conflicts continued to hinder equitable development in some nations. Nevertheless, for a significant portion of the world, life saw unprecedented improvements.

The decades following the dawn of the Nuclear Campfire era also ushered in a new renaissance of human modification. Genetic editing for desired traits became commonplace, while others pursued extensive cybernetic integration, fusing machinery with their biology in pursuit of superhuman capabilities. Some individuals chose to shed the label of 'human' entirely, embracing new forms and identities, while a smaller contingent advocated for an 'all-natural' existence. Yet, across these diverging paths, a near-universal desire emerged: the extension of life, if not indefinitely, then for a vastly prolonged

duration. The ethos of "I choose when I die" became a common refrain, reflecting a society grappling with newfound powers over life, energy, and even its own definition.

The Drowned World: Out of Context

Just as humanity seemed to be charting a course towards unprecedented stability and advancement, the universe, as it often does, introduced an unforeseen variable. A singular event, unfolding over three decades, would irrevocably shape life, leading to the world as it is known in the 27th century. For clarity within these historical records, inhabitants and elements originating from the planet Earth are often referred to as "Terran."

In the year 2107, a signal of unmistakable artificial origin was detected. Pinpointing its source was a relatively swift process; deciphering its complex data stream, however, was a global endeavor. The raw signal, made publicly available, captivated scientists and amateurs alike. Was it cosmic background noise, a relic of a dead civilization, or a deliberate attempt at communication?

Patterns emerged within hours of focused analysis. The signal contained its own decryption keys, a form of metadata with clear instructions for data extraction. It was confirmed: an intelligent message, meticulously designed for human comprehension. The message itself was an open invitation, providing schematics to construct a specialized communication device using existing Terran technology. Assembly was, by then, a trivial undertaking.

Numerous receivers were built, granting anyone access to the broadcast content. To human eyes, none of it appeared overtly "alien," as it was translated and formatted for human readability. Yet, nearly every piece of information was groundbreaking. The senders called themselves the Stillous, a multiplanetary species with a rich, ancient history. Biologically, they shared fundamental similarities with

Terrans—organ-based systems requiring nutrients for survival. However, their relationship with their own bodies was profoundly different, possessing an innate or technologically augmented ability to easily modify and replace failing organs. This unique trait was crucial to their capacity for interstellar travel. Their vessel, which had departed its origin point nearly eighty years prior to the signal's first transmission, was remarkably compact—not much larger than an average pre-Calamity supermarket, plus its necessary fuel storage and engines. It carried a population of around eight thousand, though only a handful remained in a fully "awoken" state during the journey. The majority had undergone a process of radical biological reduction to minimize mass, existing in a deep hibernative state with only their essential vital organs housed in small, interconnected life support containers, drawing minimal energy.

Their destination? Earth. This had been their explicit plan from the outset. Earth's emerging techno-signatures had become visible to Stillous long-range astronomy decades before they embarked. Through their sophisticated regional mapping of the galaxy, they had been aware of Earth as a life-bearing planet for millennia.

The Stillous history, however, revealed a crucial divergence from humanity's trajectory. Their civilization spanned four primary planets and dozens of developing colonies across three solar systems. They were also aware of at least one other space faring species, known to them as the Deaquik, or, in some Stillous dialects, the Wostouf. Beyond humanity and the Wostouf, the Stillous had no confirmed knowledge of other intelligent life. While the Wostouf had made contact with the Stillous in the distant past—artifacts traced this interaction to roughly 46,000 Terran years ago—the Stillous themselves had never directly communicated with them. Primitive Stillous, by their

own historical estimates, were already complex and intelligent, possessing the cognitive capacity for technological development for at least 200,000 years prior to this ancient contact. Yet, for reasons debated even among modern Stillous (often attributed to a lack of sustained, species-wide collaboration), they had not achieved major technological breakthroughs independently. Many Stillous believe that if not for the "gifts" bestowed upon them by the Wostouf, their civilization might never have reached for the stars.

The Wostouf culture is described as incredibly ancient. The location of their homeworld, 'Aethel,' remains unknown, and no direct communication has ever been established in Stillous recorded history. Their continued existence is a matter of speculation. All that is known with certainty is that at some point in the deep past, the Wostouf dispatched automated shuttles—capsules roughly the size of a bus—containing advanced technology and instructional material, apparently to seed technological development on worlds like those of the Stillous. These capsules are estimated to have landed periodically over approximately three decades. It then took primitive Stillous another two decades to begin interacting with the Wostouf learning materials and several hundred years to fully comprehend and replicate the technology.

The arrival of this Wostouf technology fractured primitive Stillous society. Ideological schisms formed around the purpose and implications of the capsules, creating an urgent need to fully understand the Wostouf language. In modern times, most Stillous speak their language fluently, and the Earth-bound contingent had also learned English in preparation for their arrival. While the original purpose of the capsules is no longer a primary source of conflict, violent disagreements still occasionally erupt among Stillous factions regarding the

interpretation of, and obligations arising from, the Wostouf information. The prevailing understanding is that the capsules were not a simple handout from a benevolent culture. According to some interpretations of the Wostouf documents (translated into English for Terran consideration), they clearly outline obligations for any civilization that utilizes the provided knowledge or technology.

Solit Voine, a Stillous ambassador and the appointed Director of Human Integration from the inbound ship, addressed this common point of confusion in their 34th public broadcast:

"The nature of the Wostouf Bequest has always been, and continues to be, a subject of intense debate. Our public databases contain entire libraries dedicated to this discourse, stretching back to the dawn of our recorded history. We maintain an open mind, yet all established Stillous civil societies have arrived at a similar consensus: the benefits derived from the Bequest outweigh the sacrifices entailed. To resist the stipulated obligations invites a form of friction, a cosmic resistance if you will, that ultimately proves more costly than compliance. One of the motivations for our colony's migration to Earth is the conviction that collaboration between our species will be mutually beneficial in navigating these ancient responsibilities. The knowledge delivered by the Wostouf can be understood as a contract. By utilizing their developments, one implicitly agrees to the conditions."

But what did this "contract" entail? And how could the Wostouf, with no confirmed current presence, enforce it? The Stillous provided Terran authorities with translated documents referencing the original Wostouf artifacts. While the English translations sometimes appeared vague, the core demand was stark: a recurring tribute, roughly equivalent to 5% of planetary production, delivered in the form of processed goods.

Factoring in the resources and time for constructing and launching the automated cargo vessels to Wassouf-specified coordinates, this "tax" effectively amounted to an additional 8% of total Terran productive output.

By the year 2140, a mere thirty-three years after the initial signal and still twelve years before the Stillous ship physically reached the Sol system, their impending arrival and the implications of the Wostouf Bequest were already shaping global and interplanetary policy. The Luna United Colonies (LUC), the primary governing body of Earth's moon, offered the first official grant of land to the incoming Stillous settlers. With LUC assistance and oversight, a docking and initial habitation facility was prepared for the Stillous ark.

In 2152, the Stillous vessel finally descended to the lunar surface. After LUC officials vetted the ship's contents and personnel, temporary citizenship was granted to the thousands of new Stillous colonists. To manage this unprecedented integration, humanity established the Alien Cultural Integration Agency (ACIA), with a board of Human (Terran), Stillous, and even non-biological (advanced AI) leaders. The new age had truly begun.

LandLess: Navigating the Rules - An Index & Introduction

Welcome, Howling. This section serves as your guide to understanding the core mechanics and systems that govern your survival in the Drowned World of *LandLess*. It may seem like a lot to remember at first, but don't get overwhelmed. You are not expected to memorize every rule to begin playing. This book is designed for you to reference specific explanations as you encounter more complex mechanics during your adventures.

The rules are designed to support a dynamic solo sandbox experience, blending narrative freedom with structured mechanics for challenge and consequence.

Main Gameplay Overview

LandLess is a solitaire (solo player) survival sandbox RPG. The core experience revolves around a dynamic loop:

(Explore a dangerous, water-covered world) --> **(Gather resources)** --> **(Craft/Upgrade weapons, gear, ship, and base components)** --> **(Survive environmental threats, hostile creatures, and rival factions)** --> **(Unlock and uncover information, using it to get ahead)** --> **(Fight for your territory, or strive to escape Earth's gravity well and become a space dweller).**

Understanding Game Conventions

Before diving into specific rules, let's clarify some common elements you'll encounter:

- **Dice:**
  - Standard dice notation is used: "D" followed by the number of sides (e.g., D6 for a six-sided die, D10 for a ten-sided die).
  - *LandLess* requires at least a basic set of D6 and D10 dice. A fuller set (D4, D8, D12, D20) with multiples of each is recommended for convenience.
  - Dice can be used as counters (displaying a value) or for generating random outcomes.
  - **Modifying Dice:** A D6 can function as a D3 (e.g., 1-2 = result 1; 3-4 = result 2; 5-6 = result 3). This principle applies to other dice types.
  - **Percentile Dice (D100):** Two D10s can be used. Designate one for the "tens" digit and the other for the "ones" digit before rolling (e.g., a roll of 7 on the tens die and 3 on the ones die is 73). Some D10s are already marked in increments of 10 (00, 10, 20, etc.) for this purpose.
- **Tokens:**
  - These can be any small, distinct items: coins, bottle caps, beads, pebbles, etc. A variety of colors or types is useful for representing different elements when generating game features like maps.
- **Grid Maps:**
  - The world of *LandLess* is navigated using regions divided into grids. You will generate and use maps on grid paper during gameplay.
  - **Map Types:**
    - **Region Maps:** Large-scale overviews where each grid square represents a significant section of territory. (Square grid paper recommended).
    - **Section Maps:** Local area maps showing clusters of colonies, landmarks, or points of interest. (Hexagon grid paper can be good for this).

        - **Location Maps:** Detailed layouts of specific sites like colonies, structures, or encounter areas. (Isometric grid paper can be excellent for visualizing 3D spaces).
    - Map details, landmark placement, and territory control will often be generated through game procedures.
- **Item Codes & Effect Blocks:**
    - *LandLess* features a system where dice rolls can trigger variable effects based on item properties or situational traits, rather than always determining simple success/failure or damage amounts.
    - **Weapon Codes (Example):** Weapons often have "Effect Block Codes" (or "Block Feats"). These link dice roll results to specific Tactical Maneuvers or outcomes. *(See "Combat" section, page [Page Number for Combat Rules], for full details).*
        - *Shorthand Text Example:* `D6([3][5][6])` – This means on a D6 roll:
            - 1, 2, or 3 triggers the effect in the first block.
            - 4 or 5 triggers the effect in the second block.
            - 6 triggers the effect in the third block.
        - *(Designer Note: You will need to create a visual representation/image demo for how this looks on an item card or character sheet).*
    - These codes are a core part of how events are resolved, adding tactical depth.
- **Symbols:**
    - Various items, factions, skills, and game features may have associated symbols for quick visual reference on maps, cards, or character sheets.
- **Game Terms (Keywords):**
    - Throughout this rulebook, specific game terms will be

Capitalized and defined in a glossary or when first introduced. These "Terms" have precise meanings within the rules of *LandLess*, which may differ from their everyday English usage.
    - *Example:* "Cover" refers to a specific set of combat rules (e.g., "Cover means you don't take damage from ranged attacks during Ticks 4-7 of an Action Phase, but you cannot fire during Ticks 1-2 of that same Action Phase.").

Guide to Core Gameplay Instructions:

(This index primarily covers the main rules sections. Character Creation, Lore, and Solo Play Tools are detailed in their own dedicated parts of this book, as outlined in the main Table of Contents.)

IV. Core Game Rules & Systems *This chapter lays the foundation for how the game operates, from the passage of time to basic survival.*

- **The Time System:** Understanding Ticks (Tk), Action Phases (APh), Action Turns (AT), Phases (Phs), Cycles (Cyc), and how to track them. *(See "The Time System," page [Page Number for Time System].)*
    - Every action consumes time.
    - Time-sensitive stats (Hunger, Thirst, energy) are affected when time passes.
- **Fundamental Action Resolution:**
    - *The Trait Dice Roll & Effect Blocks:* How weapons and situations trigger Tactical Maneuvers. *(See "Combat," page [Page Number for Combat Rules], and "Core Player Actions," page [Page Number for Core Player Actions].)*
    - *Tactical Maneuvers:* What they are, how they're

slotted/chosen, general impact. *(See "Combat," page [Page Number for Combat Rules], and "Character Creation," page [Page Number for Tactical Maneuvers Table].)*

    - *Non-Combat Skill Checks:* How skills are used for tasks outside of combat (e.g., dice roll + Skill Modifier vs. Target Number (TN)). Defining TNs and degrees of success/failure. *(See "Skills & Checks," page [Page Number for Non-Combat Skill Checks].)*
- **Survival Mechanics:** Hunger & Thirst (depletion, effects), Rest & Fatigue, Environmental Hazards. *(See "Survival," page [Page Number for Survival Rules].)*
- **Health & Damage:** Toughness (HP), taking damage, healing. *(See "Health & Healing," page [Page Number for Health Rules].)*
- **Mental State:** Sanity and its effects. *(See "Mental State," page [Page Number for Sanity Rules].)*
- **Inventory & Encumbrance:** Weight and Volume limits. *(See "Gear & Inventory," page [Page Number for Inventory Rules].)*
- **Core Player Actions List (Static Reference):** Detailed explanation of general actions (Move, Observe, Interact, Gather, Craft, etc.) and how they are contextualized by the environment. *(See "Core Player Actions," page [Page Number for Core Player Actions].)*

V. Combat Procedures *This chapter details how conflicts are resolved, from personal skirmishes to vessel encounters.*

- **Initiating Combat & Action Phases (APh):** Understanding the Tick (Tk) timeline within an APh. *(See "Combat Flow," page [Page Number for Combat Flow].)*
- **Making Attacks:** Using Weapon Effect Blocks, Damage Rating (DR), Fire Rate (FR), Armor Value (AV). *(See "Attacking & Defending," page [Page Number for Attack/Defense Rules].)*

- **Tactical Maneuvers in Combat.** *(See "Tactical Maneuvers," page [Page Number for Tactical Maneuvers in Combat].)*
- **Movement, Melee, Reloading, etc.** *(See relevant sub-sections within "Combat," starting page [Page Number for Combat Rules].)*
- **Ship Combat Overview.** *(See "Ship Combat," page [Page Number for Ship Combat Rules].)*

VI. Resources, Crafting & Construction *This chapter explains how to gather what you need and build your way to survival.*

- **Gathering Resources:** The "Gather Resources" action, skills, tools, environmental yields. *(See "Resource Gathering," page [Page Number for Resource Gathering].)*
- **Crafting System:** Blueprints, skills, Production Stations, time. *(See "Crafting & Repair," page [Page Number for Crafting Rules].)*
- **Building Items, Vessels, and Bases.** *(See relevant sub-sections within "Crafting & Construction," starting page [Page Number for Construction Rules].)*

VII. Exploration & Travel *This chapter covers navigating the Drowned World and discovering its secrets.*

- **World Map & Travel:** Using grids, travel time, fuel, navigation. *(See "Exploration & Travel," page [Page Number for Travel Rules].)*
- **Discovering Locations & Encounters.** *(See "Encounters," page [Page Number for Encounter Rules].)*

VIII. Solo Play & Oracles *This chapter provides the tools to run the game for yourself and generate an emergent story.*

- **Using the Oracle System:** Asking questions, generating NPC reactions, encounters, plot twists. *(See "Solo Play Tools,"*

page [Page Number for Oracle System].)

- **Mission & Job Generation.** *(See "Mission Generation," page [Page Number for Mission Tables].)*

LandLess: Creating Your Survivor

Welcome, survivor. This chapter guides you through creating your unique character for *LandLess*. You'll need this rulebook, a character sheet (see Appendix), a pencil, a standard 52-card deck (Jokers removed), and a few six-sided dice (d6).

Creating your Survivor involves several steps: defining their unique **Origin Snippet** using a card draw, establishing initial **Faction Relationships**, choosing distinct **Howling Features** through a point-buy system, assigning **Core Stats**, determining **Skills**, selecting starting **Tactical Maneuvers**, and outfitting them with **Starting Gear**.

Step 1: The Howling Concept

- **Action:** You are a Howling – a resilient survivor blending animalistic traits with human ingenuity, often augmented by scavenged cybernetics. Envision a general look or animalistic inspiration for your character (e.g., wolf-like, feline, reptilian, avian). This is primarily for your character's flavor and will be further defined by the Howling Features you select in Step 5.

Step 2: Determine Your Origin Snippet (Card Draw)

- **Action:** Shuffle the 52-card deck. Draw **one card**. This card will determine a key event or aspect of your Surviver’s recent past.

- **Interpretation:**
    1. Consult **Table CC1.A: Origin Theme by Card Suit** to find the general theme of your origin.
    2. Then, consult **Table CC1.B: Origin Snippet Detail by Card Value** for the specific event within that theme.
    3. Record this Origin Snippet on your character sheet. It may grant a small starting bonus, a unique piece of knowledge, an item, or an initial skill adjustment.

Step 3: Establish Initial Faction Relationships (Card Draw)

- **Action:** For each of the primary interactive factions (**Onyx Empire, Timberites, Howling Society (Wider), Rambas (General Standing), Stillous Remnants**), shuffle the deck and draw **one card**.
- **Interpretation:** Consult **Table CC2: Initial Faction Relationship Modifier by Card**. This will give you a starting positive, negative, or neutral modifier to your base relationship score (which starts at 0 - Neutral) with that faction. Record these modifiers.
    - *(Note: Murlyns and Breakers are typically default hostile and do not use this system for determining starting relationships; your standing with them usually starts at the lowest hostile tier).*

Step 4: Assign Core Stats

- **Action:** Record the following base values for your character's Core Stats. These may be modified later by Howling Features or Negative Traits chosen in Step 5.
    - **Toughness (HP):** Base 15
    - **Hunger:** Base 70 / Max 100

    - **Thirst:** Base 70 / Max 100
    - **Bio-Energy:** Base 10 / Max 10 (May increase with specific features)
    - **Battery Energy:** Base 0 / Max 0 (Increases if cybernetics requiring it are chosen)
    - **Sanity:** Base 50 / Max 50 (Represents a stable but untested mind; max may be adjusted by features/trauma)
    - **Carry Capacity (Weight):** Base 20 kg
    - **Volume Capacity:** Initially determined by the starting bag chosen in Step 8.
- **Description of Core Stats:**
    - **Toughness (HP):** Health Points; represents physical resilience and ability to withstand damage.
    - **Hunger:** Tracks the need for food; depletes over time (typically per Phase), penalties apply when low.
    - **Thirst:** Tracks the need for water; depletes over time (typically per Phase), severe penalties apply when low, critical for survival.
    - **Bio-Energy:** Powers some innate Howling abilities or natural healing processes; recovers with rest/sustenance.
    - **Battery Energy:** Powers cybernetics and some advanced gear; recharged via power cells or charging stations.
    - **Sanity:** Represents mental stability; can be lost through trauma, horrific sights, or extreme stress. Low Sanity can cause perception issues, skill penalties, or erratic behavior.
    - *(Other potential stats like Comfort and Fear, and their effects on recovery or imposing penalties, will be detailed in the Core Game Rules section).*
    - **Carry Capacity (Weight):** Maximum weight of gear the character can carry without encumbrance penalties.
    - **Volume Capacity:** Maximum volume of items that can fit in equipped bags/containers (distinct from weight).

Step 5: Choose Howling Features (Point-Buy System)

- **Action:** You start with **10 Feature Points (FP)** to customize your Howling's specific abilities and characteristics.
    1. Consult **Table CC3.A: Positive Animalic Features**, **Table CC3.B: Positive Cybernetic Features**, and **Table CC3.C: Negative Traits**. *(These are extensive tables you will populate based on previously discussed examples; ensure clear FP costs for positive features and FP gains for negative traits).*
    2. Spend your FP on Positive Animalic and/or Cybernetic Features.
        - **Animalistic Features:** Innate biological traits derived from their animalistic heritage (e.g., Enhanced Senses, Natural Weapons like Claws/Bite, Camouflage, Aquatic Adaptation, Toughened Hide). Each costs FP.
        - **Cybernetic Features:** Mechanical or electronic augmentations integrated into their body (e.g., Optic Implants, Reinforced Limbs, Datajack Port, Internal Comms). Each costs FP and may require Battery Energy to function (and thus increase Max Battery Energy).
    3. Optionally, choose Negative Traits to gain additional FP to spend on positive features. These add depth and trade-offs to your character.
        - **Negative Traits:** Player-chosen disadvantages or limitations (e.g., Sunlight Sensitivity, Chronic Glitch in a cybernetic, Fragile Frame, Wanted by a Faction, Tech Aversion).
    4. Record all chosen features, their mechanical effects, and any modifications to Core Stats (e.g., a Toughness

change from "Fragile Frame," an increase to Max Battery Energy from installing cybernetics).

Step 6: Determine Starting Skills

- **Action:**
  - Your **Origin Snippet** (from Step 2) may grant a +1 modifier (or similar bonus) to a specific skill or provide a choice from a small list of skills.
  - Your chosen **Howling Features** (from Step 5) may grant bonuses or inherent proficiency in certain skills (e.g., "Climbing Claws" might grant a +1 modifier to Athletics checks specifically for climbing).
  - All other skills start at a **Basic** level (representing a 0 modifier, or a base rating if your system uses direct skill ratings).
- **Record:** Note your skill modifiers or ratings on your character sheet.
- **Description of Skills:** Learned or innate proficiencies in various areas, representing capabilities in performing specific actions. They improve through play.
  - **Broad Categories (with example skills):**
    - **Combat:** (e.g., Melee Weapons, Ranged Weapons, Demolitions).
    - **Technical:** (e.g., Engineering for repair/crafting, Hacking, Piloting, Scavenging).
    - **Social & Intellect:** (e.g., Persuasion, Barter, Intimidation, Streetwise, Investigation, Medicine, Intelligence for lore/problem-solving).
    - **Physical & Covert:** (e.g., Athletics for climbing/swimming, Stealth, Survival for tracking/foraging).

- *(The detailed mechanics for how skills are rated, improved, and used in non-combat checks will be explained in the "Core Game Rules" section).*

Step 7: Select Starting Tactical Maneuvers

- **Action:** Consult **Table CC4: Starting Tactical Maneuvers**. Your character knows **two** starting Tactical Maneuvers.
  1. One Maneuver may be suggested or automatically granted by a chosen Howling Feature (e.g., "Enhanced Senses" might grant "Heightened Alertness").
  2. Choose your remaining known Maneuver(s) from the general starting list provided in Table CC4.
- **Record:** List your known Tactical Maneuvers. These are special actions or effects you can trigger in combat via your weapon's Effect Block.

Step 8: Acquire Starting Gear ("Starting Closet" Point-Buy System)

- **Action:** You have **50 Closet Points (CP)** to select your initial equipment.
  - Consult **Table CC5: Starting Closet Items**. This table lists various categories of gear:
    - **Armor:** (Head, Torso, Arms, Legs, Feet/Accessory slots).
    - **Weapons:** (Primary, Secondary – Melee or Ranged).
    - **Ammunition / Energy Cells:** For starting weapons.
    - **Medical Supplies:** (e.g., Basic Med-Patches, Bandages).
    - **Basic Resources:** (e.g., small amounts of Scrap, Fuel, Rations).
    - **Tools:** (e.g., Multi-tool, Prybar, Lockpicks).

        - **"Intel":** (e.g., Rumors, Map Fragments, useful tips).
        - **Starting Bag:** Determines initial Volume Capacity.
    - Spend your CP to select your items.
    - Equip your chosen armor and weapons. Note your starting bag and its Volume Capacity on your character sheet.
    - *(Items have stats like Armor Value (AV) for armor, Damage Rating (DR)/Fire Rate (FR) for weapons, and may have Mod Slots, as detailed in their respective tables later in the book.)*

Step 9: Final Touches

- **Name Your surviver:** Choose a name that fits your character.
- **Brief Physical Description:** Write a short description, incorporating your chosen animalistic inspiration and Howling Features.
- **Determine a Starting Personal Goal (Optional):** Roll 1d6 on **Table CC6: Initial Motivations/Goals (Optional)** or choose one from the table that aligns with your character's Origin Snippet. This can provide an initial drive for your adventures.

Your survivor is now ready to face the Drowned World of LandLess!

Character Tables

LandLess CC Table 1: Origin Snippets (Card-Based)

Draw **one card** from a standard 52-card deck. First, identify the suit for the general theme. Then, use the card's value for the specific snippet.

Table 1.A: Origin Theme by Card Suit

- **♥ Hearts (Community & Connection):** Your origin is tied to a group, a relationship, or a significant social event.
- **♦ Diamonds (Resources & Technology):** Your origin involves scavenging, trade, valuable objects, or a notable piece of tech.
- **♣ Clubs (Conflict & Labor):** Your origin is marked by struggle, hard work, a fight for survival, or ties to an organized (possibly oppressive) group.
- **♠ Spades (Loss & Secrets):** Your origin involves a significant loss, a hidden truth, betrayal, solitude, or rebellion.

Table 1.B: Origin Snippet Detail by Card Value

(This is a simplified example table. A full table might have unique entries for each of the 13 card values within each suit.)

If ♥ Hearts (Community & Connection):

- **Ace-4:** *Cast Out from Your Skiff-Pack:* You were exiled for a transgression (real or perceived). Start with -10 Reputation with "Howling Society." Gain +1 Survival skill.
- **5-8:** *Sole Survivor of a Small Settlement Raid:* Your home was destroyed. You carry a memento (a small, non-functional trinket). Gain +1 to Sanity Max.
- **9-King:** *Loyal Second to a Fallen Howling Leader:* You watched your respected leader die. You start with their basic, battered Melee Weapon (DR 3, 1 Mod Slot) in addition to your closet picks.

If ♦ Diamonds (Resources & Technology):

- **Ace-4:** *Ruined by a Bad Trade Deal:* You lost everything to a con artist. Start with 1 extra "Rumor/Intel" from the Starting Closet (free of CP cost) hinting at their whereabouts.
- **5-8:** *Pulled from the Wreckage of a Pre-Calamity Scavenge Run:* You barely survived a disastrous delve into old ruins. Start with 1 random piece of "Scrap Electronics (Advanced)" and a "Chronic Glitch" Negative Trait if you take cybernetics.
- **9-King:** *Former Gearhead for a Floater City Gang:* You know your way around tech. Start with +1 Engineering skill and a "Multi-tool" (free of CP cost). -5 Reputation with Onyx Empire.

If ♣ Clubs (Conflict & Labor):

- **Ace-4:** *Escaped Murlyn Slave-Pen:* (As per Retch's example). Start with a deep hatred for Murlyns (may gain combat bonuses against them, Oracle determines). +1 Stealth skill.
- **5-8:** *Press-Ganged into an Onyx Labor Crew, then Fled:* You have a basic understanding of Onyx procedures. Start with

knowledge of one Onyx Empire patrol route (Intel). -15 Reputation with Onyx Empire.
- **9-King:** *Veteran of a Forgotten Floater Skirmish:* You fought for survival or territory and bear the scars. Start with +2 Toughness (HP).

If ♠ Spades (Loss & Secrets):

- **Ace-4:** *Betrayed by a Close Companion:* You were left for dead or sold out. You start with a "Vendetta" against this individual (Oracle to detail them when relevant). +1 Perception skill.
- **5-8:** *Guardian of a Lost Secret/Map Fragment:* You possess a cryptic piece of information or a map fragment leading to something unknown. (GM provides this as a starting item).
- **9-King:** *Reclusive Drifter from the Toxic Outskirts:* You've survived in harsh, isolated conditions. Start with +1 to your Thirst & Hunger maximums, and a "Loner" Negative Trait (difficulty with social interactions).

LandLess CC Table 2: Initial Faction Relationship Modifier (Card-Based)

For each primary interactive faction (**Onyx Empire, Timberites, Howling Society (Wider), Rambas (General Standing), Stillous Remnants**), shuffle and draw **one card**. Apply the modifier to a base relationship of 0 (Neutral).

- **♥ Hearts (Positive Interaction / Sympathy):**
  - **Ace-5:** +5 Reputation
  - **6-10:** +10 Reputation

    - **Jack-King:** +15 Reputation (A significant positive event or connection)
- ♦ **Diamonds (Transactional / Opportunistic):**
    - **Ace-5:** +0 Reputation (Neutral, but aware of potential for mutual benefit)
    - **6-10:** +5 Reputation (A minor positive trade or shared interest)
    - **Jack-King:** -5 Reputation (A deal gone slightly sour, or they see you purely as a resource to exploit)
- ♣ **Clubs (Conflict / Negative Interaction / Subjugation):**
    - **Ace-5:** -5 Reputation
    - **6-10:** -10 Reputation
    - **Jack-King:** -15 Reputation (A significant negative event or oppression)
- ♠ **Spades (Distrust / Fear / Avoidance / Misunderstanding):**
    - **Ace-5:** -10 Reputation
    - **6-10:** -5 Reputation (Wary, but not outright hostile yet)
    - **Jack-King:** +0 Reputation (They fear/avoid you, but this might mean they leave you alone initially)

Example: You draw a ♥King for Onyx Empire (+15 Rep), a ♠3 for Timberites (-10 Rep), and a ♦7 for Howling Society (+5 Rep).

(Your Origin Snippet might also provide a specific modifier that stacks with or overrides this card draw for one faction).

LandLess CC Table 4: Starting Tactical Maneuvers

*Your character knows **two** Tactical Maneuvers at creation.*

- *One may be suggested/granted by a chosen Howling Feature or Origin Snippet.*
- *Choose the remaining from the list below. If no maneuver is granted by features/origin, choose both from this list.*

Symbol	Maneuver Name	Brief Description (Combat Focus)
	**Focus**	Your first successful shot this Action Phase deals +2 DR or ignores 1 AV.
	**Cover**	For this Action Phase, no damage from ranged attacks on Ticks 4-7. Cannot fire on Ticks 1-2.
	**Heightened Alertness**	Act 1 Tick sooner for your first shot OR force one enemy to act 1 Tick later for their first action.
	**Power Strike**	(Melee Only) Your next melee attack this Action Phase deals +2 DR.
	**Distraction**	Enemy targeting rolls are at a penalty this Action Phase OR one enemy targets randomly.
	**Precise Aim**	Your ranged attacks this Action Phase ignore penalties from partial cover.

	Quick Step	Move 1 extra grid square this Action Phase (if movement rules allow).
	**Bleed Attack**	(Requires sharp weapon) Successful attack causes target to take 1 DR at start of next 2 APhs.

LandLess CC Table 6: Initial Motivations/Goals (Optional d6 Roll)

Roll 1d6 or choose one that fits your character concept and Origin. This can provide an initial drive for your character.

D6 Roll	Motivation
	**Vengeance:** Someone wronged you, and they will pay.
	**Escape:** Get away from a dangerous past or location.
	**Discovery:** Uncover a lost secret, explore a legend.
	**Prosperity:** Acquire wealth, resources, or a better ship.
	**Belonging:** Find a safe community or a loyal crew.
	**Survival (Pure & Simple):** Just make it to the next Cycle.

LandLess: Chapter X - The Flow of Time

In the Drowned World of *LandLess*, the familiar tick-tock of old-world clocks has long since faded, replaced by a system of timekeeping suited to the rhythms of survival and the pulse of scavenged technology. Understanding how time passes is crucial for managing your actions, tracking your vital needs, and navigating the ever-present dangers.

This chapter details the unique units of time used in *LandLess*, from the fleeting **Tick** that governs combat exchanges to the **Cycle** that marks the passage of a full day and night.

I. The Hierarchy of Time: Units & Their Purpose

LandLess employs a specific hierarchy of time units. Each unit builds upon the smaller ones, creating a framework for actions of varying duration.

1. **Tick (Tk):**
    - **Description:** The Tick is the absolute smallest, indivisible moment of time tracked in the game. Think of it as a mere fraction of a second.
    - **Primary Usage:** Ticks are primarily used *within an Action Phase* during combat. They determine the precise timing of:
        - Weapon Fire Rates (e.g., a pistol might fire every 3 Ticks).
        - Reload Speeds for weapons.
        - Quick bursts of movement or dodging.

        - The exact moment a Tactical Maneuver triggers or its brief duration.
    - **Tracking:** You generally only need to count individual Ticks during an active combat Action Phase.
2. **Action Phase (APh):**
    - **Relation: 1 Action Phase = 12 Ticks (Tk)**
    - **Conceptual Length:** An Action Phase represents a single combat round – a very short window of intense, simultaneous action, conceptually lasting a few seconds.
    - **Primary Usage:** This is the core unit for resolving combat. During one Action Phase, all involved combatants will typically get to perform their actions (attack, move, use a maneuver) based on the Tick timeline. If combat continues, a new Action Phase begins.
3. **Moment (Mom):**
    - **Relation: 1 Moment = 12 Action Phases (APh)** (which is 144 Ticks)
    - **Conceptual Length:** A brief period of about 20-30 seconds.
    - **Primary Usage:** Used for very short out-of-combat activities that require more than a single combat round but less than a few minutes, such as:
        - A quick, focused observation of an immediate object.
        - A very short dialogue exchange.
        - The duration of certain rapid environmental effects.
4. **Segment (Seg):**
    - **Relation: 1 Segment = 12 Moments** (which is 144 Action Phases)
    - **Conceptual Length:** A few minutes, approximately 4-6 minutes.

- **Primary Usage:** Measures common, short-duration out-of-combat tasks:
  - A brief conversation.
  - Picking a simple lock.
  - Quickly scanning a single room or small, defined area.
  - Carefully traversing a single complex room or a short, hazardous path.
  - Using certain items that require a little setup or focus.

5. **Action Turn (AT):**
   - **Relation: 1 Action Turn = 6 Segments** (which is 72 Moments)
   - **Conceptual Length:** A significant period of focused activity, roughly **25-35 minutes**.
   - **Primary Usage:** This is the **most common unit for tracking player-driven tasks outside of combat**:
     - Scavenging or Gathering Resources in a specific location (often 1-2 ATs).
     - Crafting simple to moderately complex items.
     - Performing standard repairs on gear or a vessel.
     - Conducting a detailed investigation of a small building or a few connected rooms.
     - Engaging in a significant social interaction, negotiation, or interrogation.
     - Carefully moving across one larger grid cell on your world map.
     - Setting up a temporary, basic camp for a short rest.
6. **Watch (Wch):**
   - **Relation: 1 Watch = 4 Action Turns** (which is 24 Segments)
   - **Conceptual Length:** Approximately **2 hours**.

- **Primary Usage:** Groups together several Action Turns for longer endeavors:
  - Undertaking more complex or time-consuming crafting projects or repairs.
  - Standing guard duty for a period.
  - A period of light rest or recuperation (not a full recovery rest).
  - Detailed exploration of a medium-sized location (like a small ruin or one floor of a larger structure).
  - Short-range travel on a very slow vessel (like a basic raft).

7. **Phase (Phs):**
   - **Relation: 1 Phase = 3 Watches (Wch)** (which is 12 Action Turns)
   - **Conceptual Length:** A major portion of a full Cycle, roughly **6 hours**. *LandLess* typically divides a Cycle into four Phases: Morning, Midday, Evening, and Deep Night.
   - **Primary Usage:**
     - Tracking your character's core **Survival Needs:** Hunger, Thirst, and Fatigue/Rest (e.g., you might consume 1 unit of Food and 1 unit of Water per Phase, or specific amounts based on activity).
     - Marking significant environmental changes: shifts in light levels, tidal movements, major weather changes.
     - Calculating long-distance travel time with a vessel.
     - Undertaking extended crafting projects or significant base-building activities.
     - Periods of full rest for significant recovery of Toughness, Bio-Energy, and reducing Fatigue.

        - Natural healing from injuries or recovery from long-term ailments.
8. **Cycle (Cyc):**
    - **Relation: 1 Cycle = 4 Phases (Phs)** (which is 12 Watches (Wch) or 48 Action Turns)
    - **Conceptual Length:** One full "day-and-night" period, approximately **24 hours**.
    - **Primary Usage:**
        - Overall tracking of campaign time and the general passage of days.
        - Resetting certain abilities that are "once per Cycle."
        - The respawning or refreshing of some resource nodes or shop inventories (if applicable).
        - Triggering major world events, scheduled faction movements, or the progression of long-term consequences based on your actions.
        - Calculating sustained resource consumption for a base or a larger group of survivors.
        - Opportunities for character advancement or skill improvement during extended periods of downtime (measured in Cycles).

II. Tracking Time in Your Solo Game

As a solo player, you'll act as your own timekeeper. Here are some practical methods:

- **Combat Time (Ticks & Action Phases):**
    - **Action Phases (APh):** The simplest way is to count them as "Combat Round 1," "Combat Round 2," etc.
    - **Ticks (Tk):** During an Action Phase, you only need to track Ticks as actions resolve. A d12 can be used as a Tick counter (start at 1, count up to 12).

Alternatively, make 12 small boxes on scratch paper and mark them off. Reset at the end of each Action Phase.

- **Task Time (Segments & Action Turns):**
  - **Action Turns (AT):** This is your workhorse unit for out-of-combat activities. When a task description says it costs "2 ATs," make two tally marks or note it in your log.
  - **Segments (Seg):** For actions shorter than a full AT. Since 1 AT = 6 Segments, you can think of an Action Turn as having six "slots." If you perform several short actions (e.g., "Quick Scan - 1 Seg," "Interact with Lever - 1 Seg"), you can bundle them.
- **Daily & Survival Time (Watches, Phases, Cycles):**
  - **Phases (Phs):** Crucial for survival. Your character sheet should have a space to mark the current Phase (e.g., [ ] Morning, [ ] Midday, [ ] Evening, [ ] Deep Night). When enough Action Turns or Watches (Wch) pass to complete a Phase, check it off, advance to the next, and apply any survival effects (Hunger/Thirst depletion, etc.).
  - **Watches (Wch):** Help break down Phases. With 1 Phase = 3 Watches (Wch), and 1 Watch = 4 ATs, you know that after every 4 ATs, a Watch has passed. After 3 Watches (or 12 ATs), a Phase has passed.
  - **Cycles (Cyc):** Keep a simple running tally (e.g., "Cycle 1," "Cycle 2") in your campaign log or on your character sheet.
- **Helpful Tools:**
  - **Character Sheet:** Designate areas for "Current Cycle," "Current Phase," and perhaps a small tracker for Action Turns within the current Watch or Phase.
  - **Dice as Counters:** A d4 can track the 4 Phases of a Cycle. A d6 or d12 can track Action Turns or Segments.

- **A Campaign Journal/Logbook:** This is highly recommended. Note down significant actions, the time they took, and the current Cycle/Phase. This not only helps with timekeeping but also serves as a great record of your Howling's story.
  - *Example Log: "Cycle 5, Midday Phase. Spent 2 ATs scavenging the old hab-block. Found 3x Scrap Metal. Hunger now 60, Thirst 55. Planning to travel to the Rust Docks next; estimate 2 Phases."*

The aim is to maintain a sense of the world moving around you and to ensure that your survival needs and the consequences of time passing are consistently applied, without making timekeeping an overwhelming burden. Focus on tracking Action Turns for tasks and Phases for survival.

LandLess: Time System Reference Table

This table provides a comprehensive overview of the standard units of time in *LandLess*, their relationships, and their equivalent values in the smallest unit, the Tick (Tk).

Unit Name	Abbreviation	Relation to Next Smaller Unit	Total Value in Ticks (Tk)	Conceptual Length (Approx.)	Primary Usage Context
Tick	Tk	Smallest unit	1 Tk	Fraction of a second	Precise timing within an Action Phase (combat)
Action Phase	APh	1 APh = 12 Ticks (Tk)	12 Tk	A few seconds	One combat round/exchange
Moment	Mom	1 Mom = 12 Action Phases (APh)	144 Tk	20-30 seconds	Very short out-of-combat actions, quick observations
Segment	Seg	1 Seg = 12 Moments (Mom)	1,728 Tk	4-6 minutes	Short out-of-combat actions (e.g., picking a simple lock)
Action Turn	AT	1 AT = 6 Segments (Seg)	10,368 Tk	25-35 minutes	Primary unit for most out-of-combat tasks
Watch	Wch	1 W = 4 Action Turns (AT)	41,472 Tk	~2 hours	Longer tasks, light rest, short travel
Phase	Psh	1 Phs = 3 Watches (Wch)	124,416 Tk	~6 hours	Major survival tracking (Hunger/Thirst), long travel
Cycle	Cyc	1 Cyc = 4 Phases (Phs)	497,664 Tk	~24 hours	Overall "day/night" period, campaign progression

Key Tracking Units for Solo Play:

- **Action Phase (APh):** For managing combat rounds.

- **Action Turn (AT):** For most out-of-combat tasks like scavenging or crafting.
- **Phase (Phs):** For tracking survival needs (Hunger, Thirst) and longer activities.
- **Cycle (Cyc):** For the overall passage of "days."

This table should make it easier to understand the scale and relationship between the different time units in *LandLess*.

LandLess: Chapter X - Fundamental Action Resolution

In *LandLess*, most actions your Howling attempts – whether it's scavenging a derelict, engaging in tense negotiations, or fighting for survival – are resolved through a dynamic system that combines environmental context, your character's abilities, and an element of chance. This chapter explains the core principles of how actions are resolved.

I. The Action Card & Environmental Context

Whenever your character attempts a significant action where the outcome is uncertain (e.g., searching a ruin, trying to repair a complex device, navigating a hazardous area), the game will present an **Action Card** (or the GM/Oracle will provide its details).

- **Source of Action Cards:** These are generated dynamically based on:
  - The specific **location** or grid coordinates you are in.
  - The **Point of Interest (POI)** you are interacting with (e.g., a specific terminal, a debris pile, an NPC).
  - The general **Territory Influence** and ambient conditions.
- **Persistence:** Once an Action Card is generated for a specific POI or coordinate, it is generally "saved." If you return to that exact spot and attempt the same general type of action, you will use the same Action Card, ensuring consistency unless significant events have altered the area.

- **Content:** The Action Card is the key to resolving your action. Its most important feature is the **Effect Block Code**.

II. The Trait Dice Roll & Effect Blocks

At the heart of action resolution is the **Trait Dice Roll** used with an **Effect Block Code**. This code is found on your weapons (for combat) and on environmental Action Cards (for non-combat tasks).

- **Effect Block Code Example:** `D6([neg_effect_3][open_4][open_5][default_pos_effect_6])`
  - **Die Type:** The first part (e.g., `D6`, `D10`) indicates the die you will roll.
  - **Blocks & Outcomes:** The bracketed sections define what happens based on your die roll. Each number or range of numbers corresponds to a specific "block" or potential outcome.
    - `[neg_effect_3]`: A roll of 1, 2, or 3 on the D6 triggers the "neg_effect" that is pre-defined on the Action Card.
    - `[open_4]`: A roll of 4 triggers an "open slot."
    - `[open_5]`: A roll of 5 triggers another "open slot."
    - `[default_pos_effect_6]`: A roll of 6 triggers the "default_pos_effect" pre-defined on the Action Card.

III. Utilizing Player Talents & Open Slots

Your character possesses **Player Talents** (positive abilities, skills, or maneuvers learned during character creation or through advancement like "Adapted Traits").

- **Slotting Talents:** Before making the Trait Dice Roll for an Action Card, if the card's Effect Block Code has "open slots," you may choose to assign one of your relevant Player Talents (that matches the action's category – e.g., a "Scavenging" Talent for a scavenging action) to one of these open slots.
- **Impact:** If your die roll then lands on a block corresponding to an open slot where you've placed a Player Talent, the effect of your Talent resolves instead of a default card effect for that slot. This allows you to influence outcomes based on your character's strengths.

IV. Player's Negative Character Traits & Empty Open Slots

Your character may also have **Negative Character Traits** (chosen at character creation for benefits, e.g., "Clumsy," "Chronic Glitch"). These interact with open slots as follows:

- **If an "Open Slot" is Rolled and Not Filled by a Positive Player Talent:**
    1. **Un-upgraded Negative Character Trait Applies:** If the dice roll result lands on an "Open Slot" for which you have *not* assigned one of your positive Player Talents, AND you possess a relevant, *un-upgraded* Negative Character Trait, you **must** apply the effect of that Negative Character Trait to resolve this empty slot. If you have multiple applicable un-upgraded Negative Traits, you (or the GM/Oracle) choose one. This takes precedence over any default negative effect the Action Card might have for an empty slot.
    2. **Upgraded Negative Character Trait (Optional Use):** If your relevant Negative Character Trait has been "upgraded" (through the Skill Prestige system), you

are **not** forced to use it if you simply chose not to assign a positive Player Talent to that open slot. An upgraded Negative Trait only *must* be used if the slot would be completely empty otherwise (i.e., no positive Player Talent was assigned, and no other specific effect is available for that block from the card itself). This gives you more control over your mitigated flaws.

3. **Default to Card's Negative Effect:** If the open slot is empty (no positive Player Talent assigned) AND you have no applicable un-upgraded Negative Character Trait to fill it (or your relevant Negative Trait is upgraded and you opt not to use it as a last resort), the outcome defaults to the *first negative effect listed in the Action Card's own code for an empty or generic failure result*.
4. **Blank Result:** If the Action Card has no specified negative effect for an empty slot, and no Player Talent or Negative Trait fills it, then that specific block results in "no additional effect" or a "dud" – the action simply doesn't achieve that particular potential outcome, good or bad.

V. The Role of Skill Points (0-12 Values)

While Player Talents allow you to directly influence the *effects* within an Action Card's blocks, your character's **Skill Points** (the 0-12 value in categories like Scavenging, Engineering, Survival, etc.) play a broader, often passive or preparatory role in action resolution. *(The precise mechanics for how Skill Points modify game events will be detailed further in the "Skills System" chapter, but they may influence things like the quality/quantity of resources found from a "successful" Gather action, the time it takes to complete certain tasks, the ability*

to even attempt certain complex actions, or unlock advanced Player Talents).

VI. Degrees of Success and Failure

Success and failure in *LandLess* are often more nuanced than a simple binary outcome. They are determined by:

- Which effect block on the Action Card is triggered by your Trait Dice Roll.
- Whether you successfully slotted a beneficial Player Talent.
- Whether a Negative Character Trait was forced to apply.
- The inherent positive or negative effects pre-defined on the Action Card itself.

An action might "succeed" in its primary goal but come with a complication (a negative effect triggered alongside a positive one), or it might "fail" to achieve the desired positive outcome while also triggering a negative one. The specific Action Card will always detail these potential results within its Effect Block Code.

This section provides the general framework. Specific examples of Action Cards and their detailed Effect Block Codes for various situations (scavenging, social interaction, repairing tech, etc.) will be found throughout the rulebook or generated during play.

LandLess: Chapter X - The Cost of Survival

The Drowned World is an unforgiving place, Retch. Beyond the immediate threats of hostile creatures and rival Howlings, your own body's needs are a constant adversary. This chapter details the core survival mechanics: managing Hunger and Thirst, the necessity of Rest, and facing Environmental Hazards.

I. Hunger & Thirst

Your Howling physiology, while enhanced, still requires sustenance. Hunger and Thirst are tracked on your character sheet, typically with a maximum value around 100 (this maximum can be modified by certain Howling Features or advanced Skills).

- **Depletion:**
  - **Base Rate:** Both Hunger and Thirst decrease by **20 points per Cycle (Cyc)** under normal conditions.
  - **Activity Cost:** Strenuous or specific actions (e.g., prolonged combat, heavy labor, some Tactical Maneuvers) may indicate an additional, immediate loss of Hunger or Thirst (e.g., "Lose 5 Thirst"). These costs are cumulative with the per-Cycle depletion.
- **Effects of Deprivation:**
  - *(Note: Unlike some systems, low Hunger/Thirst in LandLess does not directly apply penalties to your dice rolls for Action Card resolutions. Instead, the penalties manifest as direct physical and mental consequences, and the risk of collapse.)*
  - **Low (25 points or less):**

        - You feel a persistent gnawing hunger or a dry, aching throat.
        - Your mental state suffers: Lose a small amount of **Sanity** (e.g., 1d3 points, or a fixed amount like 2 points) each time your Hunger or Thirst first drops into this range within a Cycle.
    - **Very Low (5 points or less):**
        - Your body begins to fail. You immediately lose **1 Toughness (HP)** when Hunger or Thirst first drops to this level (this HP loss from deprivation cannot reduce you below 3 HP from this specific cause alone; other damage can still take you lower or kill you).
        - **Pass Out Roll:** For every Action Turn (AT) you spend performing any action other than directly consuming food/water, you must make a "Pass Out Roll" at the start of that AT.
            - Roll 1d8. Initially, you pass out if you roll a 1.
            - Each time you succeed in not passing out and take another action, the target number increases by 1 (i.e., next roll you pass out on a 1 or 2; then 1, 2, or 3, and so on, up to a maximum where you pass out on a 1-7, meaning you need to roll an 8 to stay conscious).
            - This escalating roll resets only once your relevant stat (Hunger or Thirst) is raised above the "Very Low" threshold (e.g., above 5 points).
    - **At 0 Points (Hunger or Thirst):**
        - You immediately **collapse unconscious**.
        - You lose an additional **2 Toughness (HP)**.

        - If you are still alive (HP > 0), an **Unconscious Event** occurs. *(This will be determined by drawing cards from a standard playing deck and consulting a dedicated "Unconscious Event Table" – e.g., Table SV1. This table might result in being found by friend or foe, waking up later having lost items, or other narrative twists.)*
    - **Death by Deprivation:** If your Toughness (HP) reaches 0 due to the HP loss from hitting 0 Hunger/Thirst, your character perishes. A **Death Event** occurs. *(This will be determined by drawing cards and consulting a "Death Event Table" – e.g., Table SV2. This table might determine if any small part of your legacy, like a piece of unique gear or vital intel, can be found by your next character, providing a minor starting boon for a future playthrough.)*

II. Rest & Fatigue

Even a Howling needs rest to maintain peak condition. Rest is tracked on your character sheet, typically with a maximum value around 100 (this maximum can also be modified by features or skills).

- **Depletion:**
    - Rest decreases by **50 points per Cycle (Cyc)** from general activity and stress.
- **Taking Rest:**
    - You cannot choose to rest if your current Rest stat is 80 or higher.
    - **Full Rest (1 Phase - Phs):** Recovers **100 Rest** (up to your maximum). Requires a relatively safe and sheltered location.
    - **Short Rest (1 Watch - Wch):** Recovers **25 Rest**.

    - **Nap (1 Action Turn - AT):** Recovers **5 Rest**. (Risky if in an unsecured area).
- **Effects of Fatigue (Low Rest):**
    - **Tired (35 Rest or less):**
        - Your focus wanes. Lose **Sanity** (e.g., 1d3 points, or a fixed amount like 3 points) each time your Rest first drops into this range within a Cycle.
    - **Exhausted (10 Rest or less):**
        - Your mental state deteriorates further. Lose **double the amount of Sanity** (e.g., 2d3 points, or a fixed amount like 6 points) when Rest first drops into this range.
    - **At 0 Rest:**
        - You **collapse unconscious** from sheer exhaustion.
        - An **Unconscious Event** occurs (see Hunger/Thirst section, using Table SV1).

III. Environmental Hazards

The Drowned World is inherently dangerous. Specific environmental conditions can directly impact your survival.

- **Weather:**
    - Weather conditions (e.g., Calm, Light Rain, Heavy Squall, Toxic Fog, Electrical Storm) are often randomized when entering a new map grid space, even on repeat visits.
    - The specific weather will be an **Environmental Trait** on the **Action Card** for that location/grid, influencing risks, visibility, or even available resources.
- **Radiation:**
    - Certain areas may have a persistent **Radiation Level** (e.g., Rad Level 0.1, Rad Level 1, Rad Level 2).

    - For each Phase (Phs) spent in a radiated area, you lose Toughness (HP) equal to the Radiation Level.
        - *Example:* In a Rad Level 0.2 zone, you would lose 1 HP after 5 Phases (0.2 HP per Phase x 5 Phases = 1 HP). In a Rad Level 1 zone, you lose 1 HP per Phase.
    - Radiation effects may also include increased mutation risk or other negative status effects (detailed by specific location descriptions or Oracle results).
- **Travel Events (Shipboard):**
    - Each time your vessel moves one grid "block" or map unit on the world map, a **Travel Event** is triggered.
    - **Event Type (Card Draw):** Draw one card from a standard playing deck and consult a "**Travel Event Type Table**" (e.g., Table TE1). This table will link card suits/values to event categories like:
        - Weather Phenomenon (Sudden Storm, Thick Fog, Rogue Wave)
        - Hostile Encounter (Reavers, Pirates, Bio-Monster)
        - Neutral/Friendly Encounter (Trader, Drifter, Faction Patrol)
        - Discovery (Flotsam Treasure, Derelict Vessel, SOS Signal, Small Uncharted Islet)
        - Navigational Hazard (Dense Debris Field, Strong Currents, Whirlpool)
    - **Event Intensity (Dice Roll):** After determining the Event Type, roll 1d6 (or other die specified by the Event Type Table). This roll determines the **intensity or specific nature** of the event.
        - *Low Roll (1-2):* Minor version of the event (e.g., light rain, a distant Reaver sighting, a small piece of common flotsam).

        - *Mid Roll (3-4):* Standard version of the event (e.g., a squall requiring a Piloting check, a cautious trader, a significant debris field).
        - *High Roll (5-6):* Major/Intense version of the event (e.g., a violent storm damaging the ship, a pirate ambush, a rare discovery, a powerful bio-monster).
    - The specific outcomes and challenges of the Travel Event will then be played out, potentially leading to new Action Cards, combat, or skill checks.

LandLess Tables: Unconscious, Death & Travel Events

This document outlines the starting structures for tables related to critical survival outcomes and events during travel. These tables will use card draws (from a standard 52-card deck) and potentially dice rolls to determine specific results.

Table SV1: Unconscious Event Table (Card-Based)

When a character falls unconscious (from 0 Hunger, 0 Thirst, or 0 Rest), draw **one card** from a standard 52-card deck to determine the general outcome of the event after a period of unconsciousness (e.g., 1d3 Phases, or until an external factor rouses them). If any Survival stats are 0, roll a d6 and add the result to the stat or stats.

Card Suit Interpretation (General Theme):

- **♥ Hearts (Unexpected Aid / Strange Luck):** Something or someone intervenes, often not entirely altruistically, but not immediately hostile.
- **♦ Diamonds (Loss & Opportunity):** The character loses something, but a new, perhaps risky, opportunity might present itself upon waking.
- **♣ Clubs (Harsh Reality / Worsened Situation):** The situation deteriorates, or the character awakens to a new immediate problem or threat.
- **♠ Spades (Isolation & Grim Discovery):** The character awakens alone, possibly in a new, unsettling location, or makes a grim finding.

Card	Hearts	Diamonds	Clubs	Spades
Ace				
King				
Queen				
Jack				
10				
9				
8				
7				
6				
5				
4				
3				
2				

Table SV2: Death Event & Legacy Item Table (Card-Based)

If a character's Toughness (HP) reaches 0 and they perish, draw **two cards**: one for the "Nature of Demise" and one for the "Legacy Item/Clue." This system provides a small boon or narrative link for the player's *next* character in a subsequent playthrough.

SV3 needed

LandLess Table SV4: Radiation Effects

This table outlines the effects of exposure to different Radiation Levels. Characters lose Toughness (HP) per Phase equal to the area's Radiation Level. Prolonged or intense exposure can lead to Radiation Sickness.

Radiation Level	HP		

Notes on Radiation Sickness:

- Radiation Sickness is a persistent condition that may require specific medical treatment (e.g., rare chems, advanced medical facilities) to cure fully. Effects might linger even after leaving the irradiated area.
- Some Howling Features or cybernetics might offer resistance or faster recovery from radiation.
- "Mutation Risk" is a narrative element that the Oracle can introduce, potentially leading to new Negative Traits or, very rarely, strange new abilities/features.

LandLess Table SV5: Common Weather Effects

This table provides examples of common weather conditions and their potential gameplay effects. The intensity of weather (Minor, Standard, Major – often determined by a d6 roll from a Travel Event) will scale these effects.

Using Weather Effects:

- The GM/Oracle determines the current weather. It can change based on Travel Events, Oracle rolls when entering new areas, or after a certain number of Cycles/Phases.
- Weather effects often act as **Environmental Traits** on Action Cards for a location, potentially modifying TNs, risks, or available resources.
- Players may need specific gear (e.g., waterproofs, thermal clothing, respirators) or skills (Survival, Piloting) to mitigate the worst effects.

1. Toughness is how much damage you can take before you die. If you have 12 toughness and take 14 damage, you die. if you have 12 toughness and take 10 damage, you live but roll d(damage amount) and remove the result from your character. a damage of 1 would mean d1 damage so you just take the 1 damage.

Ya, fighting alone and getting 0 toughness in a fight is death then roll for death event. Fighting with an ally will do a d6 roll and if you roll a 6 then the ally will pick you up with +d3 toughness. this can happen once per fight.